

CLUE & CANDLE GAMES PRESENTS

MURDER AT THE

# Blue Lantern Club

*A 1920s Masquerade Murder Mystery Party*

8-16 PLAYERS

2-2.5 HOURS

PRINTABLE PDF



## STOP. Host only.

**This file contains the solution.**

Do not read it until all ballots have been collected after Script 4. Print it last, without reading, and seal it in an envelope. Guests must never see it.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES

# The solution

## WHO DID IT

**Remy Quill**, the art dealer, poisoned Gus with foxglove drops slipped into his gold-rimmed coupe at 11:55 pm. Remy wore a copy of Charlie Ashby's silver fox mask, so witnesses would blame Charlie, then unscrewed a fuse at 11:58 to swap back into the peacock mask in the dark.

## WHY

The three Elias Thorne seascapes Remy sold Gus were fakes painted to order. Gus had the proof, and at midnight he planned to name the dealer in front of the whole town.

## The clue chain: how players can prove it

- 1** The poison was in Gus's own coupe, drunk after 11:50. E2 E3  
 Foxglove works within minutes and Gus was well at 11:50 (E2). Only his gold-rimmed coupe held the green film; all sixty tower coupes were clean (E3).
- 2** A guest in a silver fox mask carried that coupe to Gus at 11:55. Dana R1 Avery R1 E17  
 Dana saw the fox lift it from the tray (Dana, Round 1). Avery saw it from the bandstand (Avery, Round 1). The photograph confirms it (E17).
- 3** That fox was not Charlie Ashby. E5 E6 E7 Charlie R2  
 Charlie was the only fox on the ledger (E5), but was on the lobby telephone from 11:51 to 11:59 (E7; Charlie, Round 2). Anyone who read the column had seen a sketch of Charlie's mask (E6).

- 4** The fox went into the service corridor and the fox mask was dumped there. Frankie R2 E1 E13 Avery R2  
Avery saw the fox walk through the corridor door at 11:57 and no fox in the room afterwards (Avery, Round 2). A fuse there was unscrewed by hand (E1) and the corridor door banged in the dark (Frankie, Round 2). A fox mask with no coat-check ticket was in the palm by that door (E13).
- 5** Remy Quill ordered that mask. E14 E17 E5  
Delacroix copied the mask from the Gazette sketch and the customer was R. Quill (E14, E6). The fox in the photo wore a peacock-feather pin (E17), and Remy's ticketed mask is the peacock, No. 3 (E5).
- 6** Remy took the foxglove. E8 E9 E15 Sidney R2  
The foxglove was taken between 8:30 and 10:15 pm (E9; Sidney saw the dried stems, Round 2). The only visitor in that window was R. Quill at 8:40 (E8). Green-stained gloves with crushed leaves were in the portfolio case under ticket No. 3, Remy's ticket (E15, E5).
- 7** Remy had the motive. E10 E16  
The seascapes were not genuine and Gus was told to question the dealer (E10). Gus's card shows he meant to name the dealer at midnight (E16). The cast list says Remy sold Gus those seascapes.

#### FAIRNESS CHECK

Every step uses only evidence cards and the eight core booklets (10–17). Optional characters add extra witnesses (Billie, Robin, Jesse, Kit, Emery and Marion each back up a step), but removing any of them never breaks the chain.

# Why the others didn't do it

| SUSPECT        | MOTIVE OR RED HERRING                                                             | CLEARED BY                                                                              |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Avery Lark     | Contract cancelled; in the service corridor at 11:20                              | On the bandstand in the spotlight from 11:30 and singing at 11:58 (E4, E11)             |
| Jordan Pierce  | Loses everything in the sale; argued with Gus at 11:00                            | On the balcony with Morgan from 11:50 to the blackout (E12; Frankie R1)                 |
| Sidney Hart    | Inherits only if the club is not sold (E18); botanist; in the greenhouse at 10:30 | Foxglove was already gone by 10:15 (E9); owl mask, never a fox                          |
| Morgan Bellamy | Business rival; wanted the hotel deal stopped                                     | On the balcony with Jordan (E12; Frankie R1)                                            |
| Frankie Dade   | Owes Gus \$2,000; knows the wiring                                                | Conducting on the bandstand in front of everyone (E11)                                  |
| Charlie Ashby  | Wore the silver fox; column about Gus                                             | On the lobby telephone 11:51–11:59 (E7)                                                 |
| Dana Rook      | Unpaid bills; poured the coupes                                                   | Behind the tower pouring; the fox carried the coupe away (E17); tower coupes clean (E3) |
| Leslie Croft   | About to be dismissed; leaked the will                                            | At the tower beside Robin; no greenhouse visit, no fox mask                             |
| Billie Sable   | Selling gossip; about to be let go                                                | Behind the coat-check counter all night                                                 |
| Robin Vale     | Lost savings in Gus's air-mail company                                            | At the tower beside Leslie; no greenhouse visit                                         |
| Jesse Monroe   | Never paid; sold photos to the Gazette                                            | Behind the camera taking the 11:55 photograph                                           |
| Kit Haverford  | Broken engagement; wanted the brooch back                                         | At the lobby mirror beside Charlie at 11:55                                             |
| Taylor Moss    | Knows the fuse trick                                                              | Dealing cards at table 4 in front of a crowd                                            |
| Emery Fontaine | Off the dance floor at 11:58; job offer from Morgan                               | On the terrace; no greenhouse visit, no fox mask                                        |
| Marion Kettle  | Keeps the greenhouse key; selling herbs                                           | In the greenhouse at 7:45, before the foxglove was taken; in the kitchen from 11:30     |

## IF PLAYERS ACCUSE CHARLIE

It is the trap Remy set. Point them back to the telephone slip (E7): Charlie could not be in the booth and at the tower at once.

## Script 5: The unmasking

“Friends, it is time for the unmasking. Gus Whitlock was not poisoned by the champagne tower: every coupe on that tower was clean. The foxglove was in his own gold-rimmed coupe, and at 11:55 that coupe was carried to him by a guest in a silver fox mask.

All Gull Harbor knew Charlie Ashby would be the silver fox. Charlie printed it, sketch and all. But at 11:55 Charlie was in the lobby telephone booth, reading a column down the line. So who was the fox at the tower?

At 11:57 the fox walked into the service corridor. At 11:58 a fuse was unscrewed by hand, and in the dark a fox mask was pushed into the palm by the corridor door: a mask from Delacroix Theatrical Supply, copied from Charlie’s sketch, and collected by R. Quill.

The foxglove left the greenhouse between half past eight and a quarter past ten. Only one name is in the book: R. Quill, “to sketch the orchids”. In the portfolio case under ticket No. 3, the peacock’s ticket, we found white gloves stained green. And the fox in the photograph wore a peacock-feather pin.

Why? Because at midnight Gus meant to tell us that the Thorne seascapes in his gallery were not genuine, and to name the dealer who sold them to him. Remy Quill, you knew the price of everything in this room, except the truth. Please take off your mask.

Everyone, masks off! Well done, detectives. Now let us see who solved it.”

*Invite Remy to take a bow, then go straight to the ballots and awards on the next page. On New Year’s Eve this is the moment for everyone to unmask.*

# Scoring & awards



## Answer key for the ballots

| QUESTION | POINTS    | CORRECT ANSWER                                                                                                                                                              |
|----------|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Who?     | 3         | Remy Quill                                                                                                                                                                  |
| How?     | 1         | Foxglove drops in Gus's gold-rimmed coupe, carried to him at 11:55 while Remy wore a copy of Charlie's silver fox mask; then a fuse was unscrewed to swap masks in the dark |
| Why?     | 1         | The Thorne seascapes Remy sold Gus were fakes, and Gus planned to name the dealer at midnight                                                                               |
| Key clue | Tie-break | Strong answers: the telephone slip (E7), the Delacroix order book (E14), the greenhouse book (E8)                                                                           |

## Award procedure

1. Read Script 5 and let Remy take a bow.
2. Read each ballot aloud and add up the points.
3. **Best Detective:** the highest score. On a tie, the best key clue wins.
4. **Best Costume** and **Star of the Ball:** a show of hands.
5. **Best Bluffer:** usually Remy, or put it to a vote.
6. Fill in the certificates from 34-Awards-and-Table-Signs.pdf, take a group photo with the masks off, and enjoy the rest of the party.

### THANK YOU FOR PLAYING

We hope your guests talk about the night the lights went out at the Blue Lantern for years. Clue & Candle Games.